FREE PLAYBOOK · SOCIAL MEDIA

The 30-Minute Social Media Week

How small business owners can post every week without it taking over their evenings: what to post about, eleven ways to shape a post, seven ways to open one, and a half-hour routine that keeps your feed going.

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bemoreswan.com
Written for owners who post at ten o'clock at night.

1 · THE PROBLEM

Why most small business feeds stall

It isn't a lack of ideas. It's that every post starts from a blank screen, at the end of a long day, with no plan for what comes next.

Posting when you remember

A burst of posts, then silence for three weeks. Followers forget you between bursts, and each restart feels harder.

The same post every time

Hook, problem, three tips, "get in touch". Even good content blurs together when every post has the same shape.

Selling in every post

If every post asks for something, people stop reading. They follow you for what they get, not for what you sell.

The fix

Decide **what** you post about once, vary **how** each post is shaped, and write them in **one sitting** a week. That's the whole playbook.

> THE PROMISE
>
> Three good posts a week, written in about half an hour, that sound like you and don't all look the same.

2 · YOUR PILLARS

Choose three or four things to be known for

Content pillars are the handful of topics you come back to again and again. They stop you staring at a blank screen, because the question changes from "what should I post?" to "what's this week's post about pillar two?".

Good pillars sit where three things overlap: what your customers care about, what you know better than most, and what leads naturally to what you sell.

Example: Juniper & Co, an imaginary florist in York. 1) Flowers that last: care tips and what's in season. 2) Behind the bench: the workshop, early market runs, mistakes. 3) Occasions: weddings, sympathy, birthdays, done well. 4) York: the venues, events and businesses they work with.

Write yours

#	Pillar	Why customers care	Leads to…
1			
2			
3			
4			

The four-to-one mix

For every post that asks for something (book, buy, enquire), write about four that simply give: a tip, a story, a look behind the scenes, an opinion. The giving posts earn the right to the asking one, and they're the ones people share.

Giving posts

Teach something, show something, say what you think, ask what they think. No link needed.

Asking posts

A new product, a booking slot, an offer, a sign-up. One clear ask, and say exactly what happens next.

Where ideas come from

- **The questions customers ask you.** Every question is a post, and the answer is something you already know.
- **The things you disagree with** in your industry. That's an opinion post.
- **Your week.** A job finished, a supplier visit, a small win, a mistake you fixed.
- **The calendar.** Seasons, local events and the moments your customers plan around.

KEEP AN IDEA LIST

Make one note on your phone called "Posts". Every time a customer asks something or something happens at work, add a line. When batch time comes, you'll never start from nothing.

3 · VARIETY

Eleven shapes a post can take

Same pillar, different shape. Rotate through these and your feed stops looking like one post on repeat. Only one of them is a list.

1 Short thought

One idea in one to three sentences. No list, no setup. Say it and stop.

"The best bouquets have one flower doing too much. Let it."

2 Story

A real moment: what happened, what changed. Flowing paragraphs, the lesson in one line at the end, or left implied.

The bride who changed her colours the night before…

3 Saveable list

Three to seven genuinely useful, specific items. The one shape where a list is the point.

"Five things that make cut flowers last a week longer."

4 Opinion

Take a clear position and argue it in a few short paragraphs. Nod to the other side, then hold your view.

"Floral foam should be retired. Here's why we stopped."

5 Question

A genuine question with just enough context to make it easy and tempting to answer.

"Peonies or ranunculus for a June table? Wrong answers only."

6 Behind the scenes

How the business really works: a decision, a process, a mistake, a small win. Candid and unpolished.

5am at the flower market, and what we left behind.

7 One tip, in depth

A single practical tip explained properly: what to do, exactly how, and what it changes. No "here are five ways".

How to recut stems so they actually drink.

8 Myth-bust

State a common belief, then take it apart with reasoning or an example.

"A penny in the vase keeps flowers fresh." It doesn't, and here's what does.

9 Before / after

A concrete contrast: how something looked before a change and after it, with details on both sides.

A bare registry office, then the same room an hour later.

10 Note to the reader

A short, warm letter to one kind of reader. Direct and personal.

"To the person ordering sympathy flowers at midnight…"

11 Observation

Something you noticed recently and why it matters. Loose and reflective, with no call to action.

Why everyone suddenly wants dried flowers again.

Vary the length too

Identical length is as recognisable as identical structure. Mix short (under 60 words), medium (60–140) and the occasional long post (up to about 220).

Seven ways to open a post

The first line decides whether anyone reads the second. Pick a different opening each time.

Open with…	Example
A question aimed straight at your reader	"Ordering flowers for someone you've never met?"
One concrete detail: a time, a place, a moment	"5.10am, Leeds flower market, and the tulips have sold out."
A "this is you" scenario in a line or two	"You've booked the venue, the band and the cake. Then someone asks about buttonholes."
A myth, stated plainly, then busted	"Sugar in the water makes flowers last longer. Sort of."
A bold, mildly contrarian claim	"Most wedding flowers are too big."
A sharp pain point	"Nothing ruins a dinner party like a bouquet that wilts by Sunday."
A before / after	"Monday: an empty shopfront. Friday: the busiest window on Stonegate."

Avoid: statistics you can't back up, "You didn't start a business to…", and opening every post with "Did you know…?".

TRY THIS: THREE OPENINGS, KEEP ONE

For your next post, write the first line three ways using three different styles from the table. Read them out loud and keep the one you'd stop scrolling for. It takes two minutes, and it's the quickest way to improve a post.

The second line matters too

On most platforms only the first line or two show before "more". Make the second line pay off the first: answer the question, finish the scene or give the reason. Don't make them tap to find out what you meant.

5 · RHYTHM

A rhythm you can actually keep

Consistency beats volume. Three posts a week, every week, does more than ten one week and none the next. Pick a rhythm you could keep up in your busiest month.

Day	Pillar	Shape	Purpose
Tuesday	Pillar 1	One tip, in depth	Give: something useful they'll save
Thursday	Pillar 2	Behind the scenes	Give: show the people behind the business
Saturday	Pillar 3 or 4	Rotate the rest	Every fourth or fifth week, make this your asking post

- **One platform done well** beats four done badly. Start where your customers already are.
- **Post at the same times** each week, so you're not deciding every time.
- **Reply to every comment** within a day. A conversation is worth more than another post.

6 · THE ROUTINE

The 30-minute batch

Once a week, same time, phone face down. Write all three posts in one go. Switching between writing and everything else is what makes it take all evening.

1. **Minutes 0–5: Pick.** Open your idea list. Choose one idea for each of this week's pillars and pick a different shape for each.
2. **Minutes 5–20: Write.** Write each post fast, badly, and all the way to the end. Choose a different opening line style for each one.
3. **Minutes 20–25: Cut.** Delete the first sentence if the second is better. Remove any line that would be true of every business. Read each one out loud.
4. **Minutes 25–30: Picture and schedule.** Choose a real photo where you can (your work, your space, your people) and schedule all three.

PHOTOS WITHOUT A PHOTOGRAPHER

Take five photos every working day, of your hands at work, the finished job, your space or the view on the way in. By Friday you'll have twenty-five to choose from, and real photos of your own business almost always beat stock images.

7 · THE ASK

Calls to action that aren't "DM me"

On your asking posts, say exactly what to do and what happens next. On giving posts, a gentle invitation to reply is plenty, or nothing at all.

Instead of "DM me for details"

"Three Saturday wedding slots left in May. Reply with your date and I'll tell you within a day if we're free."

Instead of "Link in bio"

"The care guide is free. Tap the link in our profile, pop in your email, and it lands in your inbox straight away."

Instead of "Get in touch!"

"Not sure what to send? Tell us who it's for and your budget, and we'll suggest three options."

On a giving post

"What's the one flower you'd never have at a wedding?" A question invites replies without asking for anything.

Only promise what's true. If you say "three slots left", have three slots left. If you mention an offer, state it exactly. Made-up scarcity gets noticed, and it costs trust you've worked hard for.

8 · MEASURE

What to look at each month

Once a month, ten minutes, the same four numbers. Likes are nice; these tell you whether social media is doing anything for the business.

Saves and shares

The clearest sign a post was genuinely useful. Make more of whatever gets saved.

Comments and replies

Conversations, not reactions. Which shapes and openings start them?

Profile visits and link taps

People curious enough to look further. Do your asking posts drive them?

Enquiries

Ask every new customer how they found you. The only number that pays the bills.

Then change one thing next month: a different shape, a different posting time, a different pillar. Keep what works.

Your weekly planner

Print this page, or copy it into a note. Fill it in at the start of your 30–minute batch.

Week of: _____

Day	Pillar	Shape	Opening	The idea in one line
Post 1				
Post 2				
Post 3				

Before you schedule

- [ ] Each post is about one of my pillars.
- [ ] No two posts this week share a shape or an opening style.
- [ ] At most one post asks for something, and it says exactly what happens next.
- [ ] Every claim, price and offer is true and up to date.
- [ ] I've cut the first sentence if the second was better.
- [ ] There's a real photo wherever I could use one.
- [ ] I've added new ideas to my list for next week.

Shapes and openings at a glance

Shapes: short thought · story · list · opinion · question · behind the scenes · one tip in depth · myth-bust · before/after · note to the reader · observation

Openings: a question · a concrete detail · a "this is you" scenario · a myth · a bold claim · a pain point · a before/after

Want your posts written for you?

Be More Swan's Social Media Assistant works the way this guide does. It plans your posts around your topics, varies the shape and the opening of every one, and writes in your voice.

Every post waits for your approval before it goes out.

See how it works at **bemoreswan.com**

